

## **PRESS RELEASE**

For Immediate Release

London, 15 December 2025

### **Judicial Review Filed Challenging MoJ/HMCTS Failure to Handle Criminal Evidence**

I am writing to draw your attention to a Judicial Review filed on 1 December 2025 (Zahmoul v Secretary of State for Justice & HMCTS/Administrative Court reference **AC-2025-LON-004293**).

An urgent, public permission hearing has been requested, but at the time of writing the matter has not yet been listed.

The claim challenges serious administrative failures by MoJ/HMCTS, specifically: (i) the failure to log, process, safeguard, escalate, or transmit serious criminal evidence repeatedly submitted to public authorities between December 2023 and May 2025; and (ii) the failure to safeguard and review the Imerman devices (a MacBook Pro and an Ubuntu computer) known to contain source-level criminal evidence, resulting in loss of chain of custody and exposure to risk.

The criminal material includes detailed forensic evidence relating to the alleged laundering of prostitution proceeds through cryptocurrency and cross-border financial channels. That evidence has been validated and is under active investigation by U.S. IRS: Criminal Investigation (IRS:CI).

A detailed Pre-Action Protocol Letter dated 19 November 2025, setting out these failures and requesting urgent remedial action, remains unanswered. In addition, formal inquiries to the solicitor of last record regarding the handling and whereabouts of the evidence and devices have received no substantive response, and the current location and status of the material is unknown.

From an administrative law perspective, the issue is not the truth of the criminal allegations but the consequences of receiving such material. Once disclosed, public authorities were required to log it, safeguard and preserve it, escalate it appropriately, maintain an audit trail, and be able to explain what was received and what was done. The Judicial Review alleges that none of these basic duties were performed, and that no records exist to account for the handling of the material.

The criminal evidence was first disclosed in December 2023 to the Judicial Office via the Private Secretary to the Master of the Rolls and was subsequently escalated to HMCTS, MoJ ministers, a court-appointed cryptocurrency expert, the High Court, and Members of Parliament. Despite this extended sequence of notifications, there was no acknowledgment, no documented administrative action, and no explanation.

The evidence, transmission history, and supporting material have now been published in the public domain for transparency and scrutiny, together with the unanswered PAP:

[https://github.com/nadiazahmoul/JR-Zahmoul-v-SSJ-HMCTS-Archive/tree/main/06\\_JR\\_Grounds\\_Evidence](https://github.com/nadiazahmoul/JR-Zahmoul-v-SSJ-HMCTS-Archive/tree/main/06_JR_Grounds_Evidence)

For ease of review: the transmission emails evidencing notice to public authorities (December 2023–May 2024) are listed first; the Criminal Referrals (CR-1 to CR-3) set out the underlying criminal evidence; and CR-4 provides the forensic key explaining the cryptocurrency tracing. The Pre-Action Protocol Letter summarises the administrative failures relied upon in the Judicial Review.

Given the nature of the alleged criminality, the international dimension, and the seniority of the public authorities involved, this raises serious questions of public interest about how criminal evidence is handled once it enters the justice system.

— ENDS —

Contact:

Nadia Zahmoul

Claimant (Litigant in Person)